



A Day in Cairo

After a traditional breakfast of *fuul* (cooked, mashed fava beans), head first for the monumental 10th-century gateway, Bab Zowaylah.

MORNING Just outside the gate, take a look at the **Mosque of Salih Talay** and the **Souk Al Khayyameyyah**, which once furnished the Fatimid armies with tents and saddles. Climb the ramparts for spectacular views over the old city. After a visit to the **Mosque-Madrasah of Sultan Mu'ayyad Shaykh**, continue along Shari' Al Mu'ez Li Dinillah until you reach the 16th-century **Al Ghuri** complex.

AFTERNOON Visit the famous 10th-century mosque of **Al Azhar**, one of the oldest educational institutions in the world. Have Arabic coffee at Suliman Café and then shop for perfume, spice, and gold in the famous **Khan al-Khalili bazaar**. If you have time, visit the **Fatimid** and **Mamluk** complexes, containing the world's densest collection of mosques, madrasahs, mausoleums, and *khanqahs* (Sufi "monasteries").

EVENING See Sufi whirling dervishes at the **Wikala Al Ghuri**, then retire to a restaurant for falafel meze and delicious fresh seafood.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Buses, minibuses, and taxis connect Cairo's international **airport** with the downtown, 12 miles (20 km) away. The **metro** and **taxis** are the simplest ways of getting around town.

WHERE TO STAY

Carlton Hotel (inexpensive) is centrally located in a 1930s building with simple but spotless rooms. www.carltonhotelcairo.com

Grand Hotel (moderate) is less grand than it once was, but the former five-story palace still offers large and comfortable rooms at good prices. www.grandhotelcairo.com

Mena House Oberoi (expensive) is a stunning 19th-century hunting lodge with breathtaking pyramid views. www.menahouseoberoi.com

TOURIST INFORMATION

www.egypt.travel

Left Fast food Egyptian-style: crunchy falafel in pita bread with cucumber, lettuce, mint leaves, and yogurt

Below One of the many glorious food and spice stands in the legendary Khan al-Khalili bazaar, Cairo

